

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

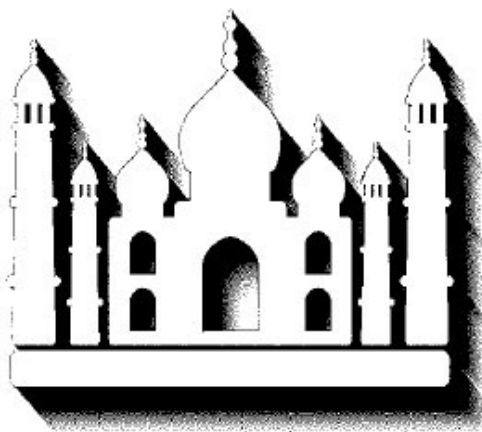
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Let's write about famous buildings and structures!



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What have you read about the Taj Majal?
- Would you like to visit a country like India? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can write about what is preferable.
- I can write about famous buildings and structures.





Let's Explore!

What have you read about the **Taj Mahal***? Nothing is comparable to seeing it.

* You use capital letters when you write about the name of a special building or structure.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Have you ever heard of the the Taj Mahal? I'd rather you went to see it yourself. However, India is a long way to travel, so I'll write about it here. The Taj Mahal is a marble tomb built by the Mughal king, Shah Jahan. He built it for his beloved second wife, Mumtaz Mahal, in the central city of their kingdom, Agra.

The Mughals were Muslim emperors who ruled in India from 1526 to 1858. The Taj Mahal was built after Mumtaz died in childbirth in 1630. The building is impressive and beautiful. It is located in a formal garden inside high walls. The famous white marble dome shines in the sunlight. It is reflected in the four long pools of water on each side of the building.

The architecture and decorations are special. There is symmetry in the lines of the building and in the geometric shapes, plants and flowers around it. Documents show that 20,000 people built the temple over twenty-two years. Personally, I've never seen a more majestic structure!





Let's Practice!

What would you rather do?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Circle all the words that are mistakes.

Eric: Hey, I'm reading about these two interesting places. Would you rather to visit the Taj Mahal or the White House?

Jason: Hmm, I'd rather visit the Taj Mahal. The dome on it looks so amazing!

Eric: I'd rather to go to the White House. I think it would be cool.

Jason: I'd rather you don't tell me that ... you're probably right!



Let's Practice!

Have you ever written about a famous building?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences.

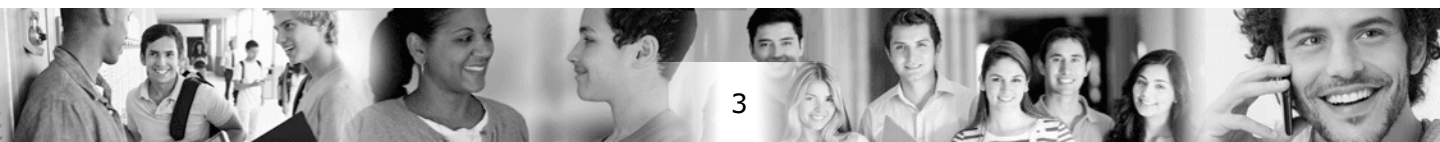
1. heard / Taj / you / Mahal / the / of / ever / ? / Have

2. structure / I've / never / majestic / more / ! / a / seen

3. I've / of / . / seen / pictures / it

4. such / They / seen / symmetry / . / haven't

5. traveled / visit / to / He's / . / the / to / tomb / famous / India





Extension Activity

Let's talk about visiting famous buildings!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of 6 famous buildings or structures.
- Write down their names on small pieces of paper.
- Your partner will do the same.
- Choose two random pieces of paper and ask your partner which one they would rather go to.
- Ask them follow-up questions to keep the conversation going.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write down the names of 6 famous buildings or structures.

☐ ☐

I choose two buildings and ask my partner which ones they would rather visit.

☐ ☐

I ask follow-up questions to keep the conversation going.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **marble** (noun): a hard stone used in sculpture and architecture
e.g. The Taj Mahal is made of marble.
- **tomb** (noun): a large burial chamber (for the dead)
e.g. The Taj Mahal is a tomb.
- **kingdom** (noun): a territory ruled by a king or a queen
e.g. The Taj Mahal was built in the center of the kingdom.
- **garden** (noun): an area of land used for growing flowers
e.g. The building is located in a formal garden.
- **dome** (noun): a large, round roof
e.g. The famous white dome shines in the sunlight.
- **pool** (noun): an area of water
e.g. There are four long pools of water around the Taj Mahal.
- **symmetry** (noun): the quality of having exactly the same parts facing each other
e.g. There is symmetry in the lines of the Taj Mahal.
- **geometric** (adjective): decorated with regular lines and shapes
e.g. There are geometric shapes, plants and flowers around the Taj Mahal.
- **majestic** (adjective): impressive; spectacular
e.g. I've never seen a more majestic structure.



Learning Points

Writing About Famous Buildings and Structures

When writing about famous buildings and structures, it is important to describe the building and give some information about it.

You use adjectives like *majestic*, *impressive* and *special* to describe a famous building.

You include facts like:

- who built it
- when it was built
- why it was built
- where it is
- how many people helped build it

You can also include information about the architecture and surrounding areas (gardens, pools etc.).

The passive voice can be used to express information about a building or structure that experiences an action rather than the person or object that performs the action. The most important thing becomes the subject of the sentence.

Examples:

- *The Taj Mahal was built in 22 years.*
- *Every year the Colosseum in Rome is visited by millions of people.*

Would Rather for What Is Preferable

You can use the expression **would rather** as an alternative to the verb *prefer*. You express your preference when there are two items of choice.

Example:

• **John:** *Would you like to visit the Great Wall of China or the Taj Mahal?*

Sandra: *I **would rather** visit the Taj Mahal.*

John: *I **would rather** see the Taj Mahal myself (than see it in pictures).*

You usually use the contracted form of the expression, **'d rather**.

- *I **'d rather** visit the Taj Mahal.*
- *I **'d rather** see the Great Wall of China.*

You use the expression **'d rather** followed by the basic form of the verb.

- *He **'d rather** write about a Modern World Wonder.*
- *We **'d rather** take pictures at night.*

